Year 6 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For staff only. Use with the Year 6 student paper (`Y06/Y06_Student_Paper_v3.1`), the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`) and the Interviewer guide for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`). The whole process, the English proficiency bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

Who this is for. Students joining UK Year 6 (age 10 to 11 in September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 4** (四年级); a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 5. The maths tests UK Year 5 content, with a few easier and a few harder items. The science tests UK Year 5 science and working scientifically.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student needs	Student paper pages
1	Welcome	2	Assessor (2.2)		1 (cover)
2	Listening (recording)	about 7	Assessor plays the recording or reads the script (3.1)	pencil	2 to 3
3	Reading paper, Parts A, B and C	12	Student alone; assessor keeps time (3.2)	pencil	4 to 9
4	Writing	10	Student alone (3.3)	pencil	10 to 11
	Break	3 to 5		water	
5	Maths	18	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (4)	pencil, rubber, ruler; no calculator, no protractor	12 to 17
6	Science	8	Student alone; assessor may read questions aloud (5)	pencil	18 to 21
7	Interview, opening with the sentence reading screen (start at **Level 5**)	12	Interviewer, 1:1 (3.4, 3.5)	sentence reading card; a plain card to cover sentences	
	Total student time	**about 67**, plus the break			

For each candidate:

- the student paper (21 pages, A4, printed at actual size: switch off "fit to page", because the diagrams and the type sizes depend on it);
- the grading sheet (`Y06/Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 5 and 6 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`), laminated;
- a clock or timer, spare pencils;
- the listening recording (`audio/v3.1/Y06/`) and something to play it on.

The written papers can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; listening is played or read to the group; the interview is always 1:1.

Marks at a glance: listening / 8, reading / 24, writing / 16, maths / 25 (number problems / 9, word problems and pictures / 16, of which word problems / 5), science / 10.

2. Before you start

2.1 Set up

- A quiet, bright room. The student sits where they cannot see other students' papers.
- Write the student's name on the paper if they cannot (in English, with the Chinese name in brackets if the family uses one).
- Have these instructions open at 3.1 for the listening script (if you are not playing the recording), and a timer ready.

Pace of speech. Year 6 students are still learning English: speak clearly and a little slower than you would to a fluent speaker, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

2.2 Welcome (say this)

> "Hello, I am [your name]. Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and plan how to help you. Some parts are easy and some parts are hard. That is fine. Do your best. If you do not understand what to do, you can ask me to say it again."

Show the cover page. Point to the "How to answer" examples and say: "Look. You tick a box, write in a box, circle, join with a line, and show your working like this."

2.3 Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English parts (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts or reading questions aloud. The student may ask for instructions to be repeated in English.	Read any question aloud in English, at the pace in 2.1, as often as the student asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0, and the grading sheet lists the NT topics.

Extra time or a reader for a known need is allowed: record it on the grading sheet. The number of **L** questions is evidence about English and goes on the grading sheet.

2.4 Stopping rules

- In every part, a student may stop when they have done what they can. Encourage once ("Have a look at the next one; some are easier"), then accept their decision.
- **Listening:** always play the whole recording, or read the whole script twice, even if the student writes nothing.
- **Reading:** let the student work for the full 12 minutes. Stop early only if the student has answered nothing in Part A after 4 minutes, or is upset; record "stopped after 4 minutes" on the Reading front sheet.
- **Writing:** if the student cannot start, say once: "You can write words, or draw and label your plan." Never write for them.
- **Maths and science:** stop at the time. A student who is stuck may be told: "You can go on to the next question."
- A distressed child is never pressed: stop, take a break or end the session, and record it on the grading sheet.

2.5 Keeping the student at ease

- Sit beside rather than opposite if you can. Smile, use the student's name, and praise effort ("Thank you, you are working hard"), not answers.
- Do not show marks or say whether an answer is right.
- Say how many parts are left. Offer water and the break after the writing.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 7 minutes with the recording, / 8)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y06/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. It says the instructions below, reads the eight questions aloud once, plays the script twice (20 seconds apart) and gives one minute to finish, so you do not say or read anything yourself. The two speakers have different voices, so it does not say their names. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of the script takes about 1 minute 48 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

Say: "Turn to page 2. I am going to read a phone conversation between two friends, Aisha and Jun. They are talking about a film night in the park at Mid-Autumn. First I will read the questions to you. Then I will read the conversation two times. You can answer while I read. Answer on pages 2 and 3."

Read the questions aloud once, slowly, pointing to each number. Do not name or explain the pictures.

> "Question 1. Where will Aisha and Jun meet? Tick one box. Question 2. What time will they meet? Tick one box. Question 3. What must Jun bring? Tick two boxes. Question 4. Who is going to the film night with Aisha? Tick one box. Question 5. How wide is the screen? Question 6. What can they buy in the park? Question 7. Why does Aisha change the place where they meet? Question 8. Jun's piano lesson finishes at six o'clock. Will he be late? Tick yes or no, and explain your answer."

Say: "Now listen. I will read the conversation two times."

Read it twice clearly and steadily, a little slower than normal speech, with a short pause after each sentence. Read both parts yourself: say each speaker's name before their words, and change your voice a little. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, wait 20 seconds, then say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish.

Aisha: Hello, Jun. It's Aisha. Are you still coming to the film night in the park on Saturday?

Jun: Yes! My mum says I can go. Where shall we meet?

Aisha: I said the main gate of Riverside Park, but it gets very crowded there. Let's meet outside the library instead. It's just across the road from the park. [pause]

Jun: OK, outside the library. What time?

Aisha: The film starts at seven o'clock, but we want to find a good place to sit. Can you be there at a quarter past six?

Jun: A quarter past six. My piano lesson finishes at six, and it's only ten minutes from the library. So that's fine. [pause]

Aisha: Great. My dad is coming with us, and my little brother, Leo.

Jun: Do I need to bring anything?

Aisha: Bring a jacket, because it gets cold by the river at night. And bring a little money, about twenty yuan. Dad says we can buy mooncakes there. [pause]

Jun: Is the screen really big? My cousin says it's fifteen metres wide!

Aisha: Yes, it's the biggest outdoor screen in the city. The film is about a panda who travels to the Moon, so it's perfect for Mid-Autumn. [pause]

Jun: What if it rains?

Aisha: Then the film night will be on Sunday instead. Dad will send your mum a message.

Jun: Perfect. See you on Saturday!

Answers. 1 mark each. Spelling and grammar are not marked in listening; the answer must be in English and the meaning must be clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept	What it tests
1	**B** library		A park gate (the first plan, changed)	a change of plan
2	**B** 6:15		A 6:00 (the piano lesson ends), C 7:00 (the film starts)	"a quarter past"; distractor times
3	**A** jacket and **C** money	both ticked and nothing else	umbrella (rain is mentioned), torch (it will be dark, but she does not ask for one)	two details
4	her dad and her little brother		her cousin (only mentioned)	detail
5	**15**	fifteen	50 (fifteen and fifty sound alike)	number
6	mooncakes	moon cakes, mooncake, any recognisable spelling	a film; tickets	key word
7	The main gate gets very crowded.	crowded; too many people there; "many people"	"the library is near the park" (true, but not the reason)	reason stated in the text
8	**No**, because the lesson is only ten minutes from the library, so he gets there at about ten past six, before a quarter past six	No with any reason about the ten minutes or arriving before 6:15	Yes; No with no reason	inference: combines three facts

Band guide

Score	0 to 2	3 to 4	5 to 6	7	8
Listening band	**A**	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**

What to look for

- Questions 1 to 4 need key words and pictures. A student who gets these but none of 5 to 8 usually knows familiar words but cannot yet follow connected speech (band B).
- Questions 1 and 2 have distractors: the first meeting place and the other times in the conversation. Choosing them shows the student caught words but missed the change ("instead", "but").
- Question 8 needs three facts combined (six o'clock, ten minutes, a quarter past six): it separates D from E.
- Compare with "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, / 24)

Say: "Turn to page 4. This is the reading. There are three parts: A, B and C. Read the texts and answer the questions. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. I cannot help you with the words, but I can say the instructions again. You have 12 minutes."

Start the timer. Say "Two minutes left" at 10 minutes and "Please stop" at 12 minutes. Do not read any text or question aloud and do not explain words.

Marking. Spelling is not marked unless the word cannot be recognised. For "find and copy" the word must be the right word from the text; a small copying slip is fine. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: the café menu (questions 1 to 7, / 8)

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Notes
1	1	¥20	20, 20 yuan	
2	1	10	ten	
3	1	**A** noodle soup		uses the chilli picture and the key
4	1	milk tea		
5	1	20:00	8 pm, eight o'clock, 8 in the evening, 20.00	7:30 is the opening time
6	2	open on Mondays: **False**; fried rice costs more than an egg sandwich: **True**	1 mark each	the second needs a comparison (¥15 and ¥12)
7	1	a drink	a free drink; any drink on the menu	"rice", "food"

Part B: The Rainy Day Picnic (questions 8 to 15, / 8). A story about two years below age level.

Q	Marks	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
8	1	Sunday	on Sunday; Sunday morning	Saturday
9	1	fruit and a blanket	both ticked and nothing else	sandwiches (Mum made them)
10	1	red		
11	1	a (big) plant	plant; a flower pot	"a tree" (that is what she called it)
12	1	It started to rain.	it was raining; there was rain; dark clouds and rain	"it was cold"; "Tom was crying"
13	1	Tom's toy animals	toy animals; toys; animals	"a lion" on its own; "sandwiches"
14	1	sad		angry, hungry
15	1	They were enjoying the indoor picnic so much: it was fun, and they did not need the park any more.	any reason about enjoying the indoor picnic or having fun at home; "they were happy at home"	"because it was raining" (it had stopped); a retelling with no reason

Part C: How Seeds Travel (questions 16 to 23, / 8). Age-appropriate non-fiction for a fluent reader of 10.

Q	Marks	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
16	1	retrieval	a tiny parachute of soft hairs	parachute; soft hairs	the wind on its own
17	1	retrieval	Its thick, hairy outer layer traps air.	it has air inside; it is full of air	"it is big"; "it is light"
18	1	vocabulary	survive		grow
19	1	vocabulary in context	move slowly with the water		
20	1	vocabulary in context	being carried by an animal		
21	1	retrieval and inference	any one: too much shade or not enough light; they must share water; they must share space	too dark; no sun; too crowded; not enough water	"the parent eats them"
22	1	inference: applies the text	The seed passes through the bird's body and is dropped in the garden (in its droppings) after the bird flies there.	the bird carries the seed inside it to the garden; the bird drops the seed there	"the wind blows it" (no link to the bird)
23	1	author's purpose	To give a real example: the hooks on burdock seeds gave a person the idea for Velcro.	to show that nature can give people ideas; to make the text more interesting with a true story; to link seeds to something children know	retelling ("because he had a dog")

Band guide

Result	Band
Part A under 4	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3	**C** Developing competence
Part C 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part C 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example, Part C higher than Part B), and check against the sentence reading screen. Record the reading paper marks and the reading band on the **Reading front sheet** and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Picture support.** A student who scores mainly on questions 1 to 3 may be using the menu pictures and prices, not the words.
- **Copying.** A pattern of copying words that sit next to the question words suggests word matching without understanding (for example "the wind can carry them" for question 16).
- **Inference and purpose.** Questions 21 to 23 separate D from E. A student at band C often gets the retrieval questions and leaves the "why" and "explain" questions blank.
- **Speed.** A student who is accurate but does not reach Part C may decode slowly: check the fluency rating from the sentence reading screen (Reading front sheet) before giving a low band.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, / 16)

Say: "Turn to page 10. This is the writing. Choose A or B, and tick the one you choose. You can plan in the box on page 11, then write on the lines. Write as much as you can. You have 10 minutes."

The task. A: a story that starts when a small robot with an envelope knocks at the door (picture and question prompts). B: a letter to a student in the new class about themselves (prompts for content). Do not give a higher mark

for either choice. In B, the content tells you about the student too: pass anything useful to the interviewer.

Criteria. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 sit between the descriptions). Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or only words copied from the page	A few connected ideas on the topic in a simple order; may be short (3 to 6 sentences) or a list; a letter may have no opening or ending	A complete piece that fits the task: a story with an opening, a problem and an ending, or a letter with a greeting, several developed points and a closing; ideas link across sentences; paragraphs
Vocabulary	No English words, or single words not on the topic	Everyday words that carry the meaning; a few topic words; much repetition (nice, good, like)	Varied, precise words for a 10 year old: chosen verbs, adjectives and adverbs; some ambitious words used correctly
Grammar and sentences	No sentences	Simple sentences with mostly correct word order, joined with and, then, because; frequent errors in tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear	A range of sentences (with when, if, because, although, so that); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling cannot be read; no punctuation	Common words mostly correct, others spelt as they sound; capital letters and full stops sometimes	Most words correct, including less common ones; sentence punctuation secure; commas, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct

The writing band is given by best fit with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, not by the total alone. As a rough guide only: totals of 0 to 3 usually fit **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E at this age. A fluent writer of 10 to 11 usually writes about 120 to 200 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending suited to the form (a story ending, or a letter's closing such as "I hope to meet you soon"). Sentences vary in length and type, vocabulary is chosen for effect, and dialogue in a story is mostly punctuated correctly. Common words are spelt correctly and harder words plausibly. The errors are the ones any 10 year old makes, not the features of a learner of English (missing "a" and "the", missing past tense -ed or plural -s, Chinese word order).

What to look for

- **Learner features** (missing -s, -ed, articles; "I very like"; "There have many ...") point to C or D even when the content is good.
- **Memorised chunks** in letter B ("My name is ... I am 10 years old. My hobby is ...") with little else usually fit B. Look for what the student adds beyond the textbook pattern.
- **A full plan and little writing** may mean slow writing in English rather than no ideas: say so in the notes on the grading sheet.

3.4 Speaking: the interview (about 8 minutes of questions)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y5_Y6` and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y5_Y6`). The interviewer records the speaking band and "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet, and speaks at the pace in 2.1. If the listening task (3.1) and listening in conversation differ by more than one band, note why on the Interview sheet.

3.5 Reading aloud: the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (opens the interview, 3 to 4 minutes)

Use `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`. The rules, the interviewer's copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the record is the **Reading front sheet**. **Start at Level 5 (sentence 13)** for Year 6. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Follow the guide's rules for going back, stopping and the meaning checks. Use the "Years 6 to 10" column of the guide's reading age table to turn the reading age into an indicative band, and use it to confirm the reading paper band.

4. Maths (18 minutes, / 25)

Say: "Turn to page 12. This is maths. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and pictures. You can use a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 18 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 content, with easier floor items (Year 4) and ceiling items (Year 6). Section A, number problems: 9 marks. Section B, word problems and pictures: 16 marks, of which **word problems: 5 marks** (questions 11, 12, 15 and 18). Every Section B question has a picture, chart, table or diagram.

Marking. Give the mark for a correct answer with or without working. Units are printed in the answer boxes, so they are not needed. Accept answers in a different but correct form unless the question asks for a particular form.

4.1 Section A: number problems (/ 9)

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught (Chinese Grade 4 completed)
1	Add 4-digit numbers (Y4, floor)	1	7 003	7003	6 993, 7 993: carrying slips	
2	12 times table (Y4, floor)	1	108		98, 118	The 11 and 12 times tables are often not learnt (tables go to 9 × 9). Working it out (10 × 9 + 2 × 9) is good reasoning.
3	Round to the nearest 10 000 (Y5)	1	490 000	490000	480 000 (cuts off), 486 000, 500 000	Usually taught in Grade 4 with 四舍五入 to the nearest 万 (48万6350 ≈ 49万), so this should be familiar; the digit grouping in threes may look new.
4	Compare decimals to 3 places (Y5)	1	0.5 circled		0.405 or 0.054: thinks more digits means bigger	Comparing decimals is usually Grade 4.
5	Short division with a remainder (Y5)	1	142 remainder 5	142 r 5; 142..... 5 (Chinese notation); 142 5/6	143 (rounds up), 141 remainder 11 (remainder bigger than 6)	Division with remainders (有余数的除法) is taught from Grade 2; the word "remainder" may be new.
6	4-digit × 2-digit (Y5)	1	78 338	78338	17 030: multiplies by 2 instead of 20 in the second row	Three-digit × two-digit is Grade 4; the method is the same.
7	Mixed number to improper fraction (Y5)	1	11		9 (2 + 3 + 4), 6, 14	Mixed numbers and improper fractions (带分数, 假分数) are usually Grade 5.
8	Add fractions with related denominators (Y5)	1	5/6	10/12 or any equivalent	3/9: adds tops and bottoms	Adding fractions with different denominators (异分母分数加法) is usually Grade 5.
9	Long division (Y6, ceiling)	1	32		31 remainder 23	Division by a two-digit number is Grade 4, so many students will get this.

4.2 Section B: word problems and pictures (/ 16)

W = word problem.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
10	Read a timetable; time intervals (Y5)	2	(a) 10:02 (b) 59 minutes	1 mark each	(b) 99 (subtracts the times like decimals: 12.09 – 11.10), 61, 1 hour 1 minute	Time intervals (经过的时间) are Grade 3; a UK-style timetable may be new.
11 W	Division: use the remainder (Y5)	1	4 buses	4	3 remainder 30, 3.75, 3: does not round up for the context	
12 W	Money with decimals, two steps (Y5)	2	¥9.50	9.5; 9元5角. 2 marks: 9.50. 1 mark: 40.50 (3 × 13.50) seen with no correct second step, or a correct method with one slip	36.50 (50 – 13.50: forgets the 3 notebooks); 40.50 as the final answer	Decimal money calculation is Grade 4.
13	Volume by counting cubes (Y5)	1	24 cm^3	24	12 (counts the top only), 26 (counts the squares you can see: 12 + 8 + 6)	Volume (体积) is usually Grade 5; counting hidden cubes may be new.
14	Perimeter and area of a composite shape (Y5)	2	(a) 36 cm (b) 50 cm^2	1 mark each	(a) 25: adds only the four labelled sides; (b) 80 (10 × 8, ignores the missing corner)	Rectangle area and perimeter are Grade 3; composite shapes (组合图形) are usually Grade 5. Finding the missing sides (6 cm and 5 cm) is the skill.
15 W	Measures: litres and ml, two steps (Y5)	1	500 ml	500	0.5 (right amount but in litres: 0, note it), 1 250 (subtracts one cup), 1 000	Litres and millilitres (升和毫升) are Grade 4 in some textbooks and Grade 5 in PEP.
16	Prime numbers (Y5)	1	11 and 23 circled, and nothing else		9, 15, 21, 27 circled: thinks odd numbers are prime	Prime numbers (质数) are usually Grade 5.
17	Angles on a straight line and around a point (Y5)	2	(a) 56° (b) 120°	1 mark each	(a) 124 (copies), 236; (b) 30, 210 (forgets the right angle)	平角 (180°) and 周角 (360°) are usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
18 W	Percentages as hundredths (Y5)	1	35%	35	65 (adds the two numbers given)	Percentages (百分数) are usually Grade 6; a student may still reason that 35 out of 100 is 35%.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers and what they mean	May not have been taught
19	Reflection in a mirror line (Y5)	1	The reflected shape is on the right of the line, the same distances away: its long upright side is 4 squares right of the line, its top runs from 2 to 4 squares right, its bottom from 1 to 4 squares right, and its sloping side is nearest the line.	Small drawing inaccuracy if every corner is in the right square	The same shape slid across (sloping side on the far side): a translation, not a reflection	Reflection on a grid (轴对称) is usually Grade 4, so this should be familiar.
20	Line graph with negative numbers (Y5; (b) is a Y6 ceiling item)	2	(a) –5 °C (b) 13 degrees	1 mark each; (a) "minus 5", "5 below zero"	(a) 5 or –6; (b) 3 or –3: works out 5 – 8 instead of 5 – (–8)	Line graphs (折线统计图) are usually Grade 5 and negative numbers Grade 6.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 25	0 to 9	10 to 14	15 to 21	22 to 25
Maths band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

List the NT questions on the grading sheet and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

Topics that may not have been taught to a student who has completed Chinese Grade 4: the 12 times table (2), mixed numbers and improper fractions (7), adding fractions with different denominators (8), volume (13), composite shapes (14), litres and millilitres (15), prime numbers (16), percentages (18), line graphs and negative numbers (20). Rounding large numbers, decimals, long multiplication and division, time, money, angles on a line and around a point, and reflection (1, 3 to 6, 9 to 12, 17, 19) are usually taught by the end of Grade 4. Textbooks differ (PEP, 苏教版, 北师大版), so always ask the student.

4.3 What to look for

- **Number problems against word problems.** A student who scores well on number problems (Section A) but poorly on the word problems (11, 12, 15, 18) may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the answer then comes quickly, record it as an English barrier on the grading sheet.
- **Method.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately. A correct answer without working is fine. When an answer is wrong, look at the working: one slip in a sound method is a different need from a wrong method.
- **Conventions.** "Remainder" in words, timetables, "Not drawn accurately", cm^3 and the percentage sign may be new. A student who shows the maths correctly with a picture or working knows the maths, even if the English words are new.

5. Science (8 minutes, / 10)

Say: "Turn to page 18. This is science. Every question has a picture or a table. If you want me to read a question to you, put up your hand. You have 8 minutes."

What it tests. UK Year 5 science and working scientifically. Question 7 is the table and fair test question.

Q	Content (UK year)	Marks	Answer	Also accept, partial credit	Common wrong answers	May not have been taught
1	Life cycle of an amphibian (Y5)	1	**A** (the young frog with legs and a tail)		B fish: thinks a tadpole becomes a fish	Life cycles (for example the silkworm, 动物的一生) are often taught by Grade 3, so the idea should be familiar.
2	Reversible and irreversible changes (Y5)	2	Reversible: A, C. Irreversible: B, D.	2 marks: all four correct; 1 mark: three correct	A under irreversible: thinks melted chocolate cannot set again	Reversible and irreversible changes are often later (Grade 6 in some textbooks); the meaning of the two words is given on the page.
3	Separating mixtures (Y5)	2	sand and water: filtering; salt dissolved in water: evaporating; small stones and sand: sieving	2 marks: all three; 1 mark: one or two correct	salt water joined to filtering: thinks filtering removes dissolved salt	Dissolving (溶解) is usually Grade 4; separating by filtering and evaporating may be new.
4	Day and night (Y5)	1	The Earth spins around once every day.		"The Sun moves around the Earth": an everyday idea, not an English problem	The Earth's movement is often Grade 5 or 6.
5	Gears (Y5)	1	anticlockwise	an anticlockwise arrow drawn on gear B	clockwise	Simple machines (levers, pulleys and gears) are often Grade 6. The arrows on the page show the meaning of the two words.
6	Forces: gravity and air resistance (Y5)	1	1 air resistance, 2 gravity	both for the mark, in English; spelling not marked; an answer in Chinese scores 0	the two swapped; magnetism	Forces are taught in different grades; the English names may be new.
7	Reading a table; conclusion; fair test (Y5, working scientifically)	2	(a) The bigger the parachute, the longer it takes to fall. (b) any one: the same height; the same weight or load; the same paper or material; the same strings; drop it the same way or in the same place	1 mark each; (b) "same toy", "same high"	(b) "same size" (that is what she changes), "same time" (that is what she measures)	Fair testing in this form is less familiar; judge the student's thinking.

Band guide (provisional)

Score / 10	0 to 3	4 to 5	6 to 8	9 to 10
Science band	**1** Well below expected	**2** Working towards	**3** Expected	**4** Greater depth

What to look for

- **Working scientifically.** Question 7 shows scientific thinking separately from topic knowledge. A student who gets 7 right but marks other questions NT is likely to do well once taught.
- **An English barrier** looks like wrong answers that depend on English words (reversible, evaporating, air resistance) while the picture questions (1, 5) are right. Reading the question aloud, or once in Chinese (L), usually settles it.
- **Everyday ideas** (the Sun moves around the Earth; heavier things always fall faster) are science misconceptions, not English problems.

6. Recording the results

1. Mark the student paper (every question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet (`Y06_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). In maths, also record on the grading sheet whether the number problems against the word problems (Section A / 9, word problems / 5) show an English barrier in maths: yes, no or unsure (see 4.3).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet.
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student paper with them (or shred it under the school's policy).